



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 03/28/2026	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident.
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: An organized group of ethical hackers. • What: The company suffered from a ransomware attack. • When: Approximately at 9:00 a.m. • Where: At a health care company. • Why: The attack was a success because the employees have suffered from phishing attacks on their emails. The emails contained malicious malware to obtain access to the organization's network along with ransomware. Once the employees downloaded the malicious file, the attackers were able to access the network and deploy the ransomware.
Additional notes	One way to prevent further similar incidents is by educating employees about phishing techniques, as well as, alerting them to be cautious with any installations or suspicious attachments. To recover the access without paying, the organization needs to back up the files in a device where the attacker can't reach, this is known as offline backup.

Date: 03/31/2026	Entry: #2
Description	Documenting a common example of data exfiltration attack.
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A malicious hacker. • What: The company suffered from a phishing to data exfiltration attack. • When: At 2:24 a.m. • Where: At a medium size software development company. • Why: The organization did not have security controls in operation to protect against data exfiltration attack. Due to that, the attacker gained access to the network through phishing techniques. With the access, they could perform lateral movement, looking for any valuable information, reduce the size of it and bypass security controls, and finally exfiltrate the stolen data to their chosen destination, using compromised email accounts.
Additional notes	Adhering to security controls, such as multi-factor authentication (MFA) methods, network monitoring, SIEM tools, and firewall management, would prevent any organization to suffer from data exfiltration attacks.

Date: 04/08/2026	Entry: #3
Description	Documenting an cyber security incident investigation.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A malicious hacker. • What: An employee received an email containing malware. • When: At 9:30 a.m. • Where: At a financial services company. • Why: The incident happened because an employee opened and entered their password in an attachment that contained malicious software on it.
Additional notes	To verify if the file is malicious, it was first converted into a hash. Then, the hash was analyzed using the VirusTotal tool to check its authenticity.

Date: 04/10/2026	Entry: #4
Description	Documenting an incident final report.
Tool(s) used	SIEM tools.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A malicious hacker. • What: PII and financial data exfiltration. • When: At 7:20 p.m. • Where: At an organization's e-commerce web application. • Why: Due to a vulnerability in the application, which allowed the attacker to perform a forced browsing attack and get access to all the application's data, including the confidential ones.
Additional notes	The recommendations for these types of incidents are: • Perform routine vulnerability scans. • Specify a set of reliable URLs and block the others. • Control the authentication and authorization regulations.

Date: 04/15/2026	Entry: #5
Description	Documenting a phishing alert incident.
Tool(s) used	Phishing Playbook and SIEM tool
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A malicious hacker • What: Download of a suspicious file attached in a phishing email. • When: At 9:30:14 a.m. • Where: At a financial services company. • Why: An organization's employee has opened a phishing email and downloaded a password-protected attachment that contained a malicious executable file.
Additional notes	The evidences that lead the SOC analyst level 1 to identify the file as malicious were: • The email contained various spelling and grammar errors. • The file was converted into hash and then investigated. • The file download event was alerted by a SIEM tool.
